Part 2: Where does the "average" member of your group live?

The assignment

The question

Crime is shaped by place. To explain crime among immigrants, you first need to know what the places where they live are like. **In what kind of city does the average member of your group live, and how does that city compare with the nation?**

Length and format

Your paper must be at least 4 pages of text. Double-spaced, 12-point font, 1-inch margins. References and tables, figures and graphs do **not** count toward the 4 pages, so a paper with 3 pages of text and 2 pages of figures is too short.

What you do

1. **Find your cities.** Use the 50 cities where your group is largest. The tool finds them for you (see the next page). It uses 343 cities with more than 75,000 residents in 2000, 2006-2010 and 2020-2024.
2. **Choose 3 indicators** from these 7: poverty percent, unemployment percent, median household income, bachelor's degree percent, renter percent, Black percent, Hispanic percent. Be ready to say why you chose them.
    - Use the **whole city's** value, not your group's. Example: the median income of *all* households in the city, not of your group's households.
3. **Calculate weighted averages.** For each indicator and each period, calculate:
    - **Weighted average** = sum of (group size x city value) / sum of group sizes. This is the **average member of your group**.
    - **National value.** Then compute *weighted average minus national* yourself.
4. **Make one figure or table per indicator**, showing all three periods. In the tool, **Make a figure** builds a titled chart, a table, or both for the indicator you choose, with the national values beside your weighted averages. Follow the formatting video and spreadsheet, and number each figure with a short caption.
5. **Write the profile** (it must be 4 pages of text, see Length and format). Draft with placeholders such as [Figure 1 about here] and add the figures last. This keeps the story flowing.

How to write the comparison

> Members of this group lived in cities where XX.X% of people were below the poverty level, compared with XX.X% nationally. The average member's city was X.X points higher than the nation.

Answer these in your text

1. What are conditions like in the average member's city, for each indicator?
2. How did they change across 2000, 2006-2010 and 2020-2024? Did the gap between the average member's city and the nation grow or shrink?
3. Does the group live in cities with high immigration in general? Did that change?
4. How does the national value help you read the average member's city? What would be missing without it?
5. What does a weighted average hide? Think about cities where the group is small.
6. A city line is political, not a neighborhood. What could differ inside these cities?
7. What share of your group lives in these 50 cities? What does that mean for how far your results describe the whole group?

Hand in

Profile text, one figure or table per indicator, your Top 50 CSV (data appendix), and an APA references page. **Paste your completion code and record line at the top of your submission**, before the text.

Note on income: income is published in each period's own dollars. Tick the "2024 dollars" box in the tool so periods are comparable, and say in your paper which you used.

Part 2: Getting and checking the data

Instructions for the community-context tool. Read with the assignment handout.

Tool: https://nu-stats.github.io/community-context/. Laptop or desktop only, no phone. Use the **same browser** every time, **not a private window**, and do not clear site data. The tool keeps your place there.

Get the data (about 10 minutes)

1. **Start here tab.** Save your @northeastern.edu email. Your quiz and look-ups are tied to it, and it goes into your completion code. Pick your **group** (59 countries of birth), then choose the ranking period your assignment names and **Part 2**.
2. **Indicators.** Population and foreign-born percent are fixed. Choose your 3 indicators, the same ones in every period.
3. **Top 50 tab.** Your 50 cities, each with its group size (the weight) and the values for each period. A blank means no Census value, so that city is left out of that indicator. Download the **CSV**.
4. **Data tab.** All 343 cities, sortable, if you want to check the Top 50 by hand.

Pass the three learning checks (about 30 minutes)

Results stay hidden on the **Weighted averages** tab until you pass A, B and C. They check that you understand the numbers.

Step	What you do	If you miss
A. Predict	Say whether your weighted average will be higher, lower or about the same as the plain average (same means within 2%).	No wrong answer. You see the true answer and why.
B. Learn	Watch the 2-minute video, then answer 5 questions. Some use your own data and some are concepts.	1st miss: a hint. 2nd miss on a question: a **60-minute lockout** and a new question. 3rd lockout: meet your instructor for a release word.
C. Look up	Three random cities each hide one value ("look up"). Find each on data.census.gov (Census 2000, or the ACS for the period shown) and type it in.	Matches to the rounding shown (percent to 1 decimal, population as a whole number). 3 wrong tries: 60-minute wait.

Do not leave the checks to the last minute. A lockout the night before the deadline cannot be waited out.

After you pass

The results appear: a table of the national values, then a table of **your weighted averages** laid out the same way, with one row per variable and one column per period. Open **Calculations summary** to see every value used (number of cities, sum of the weights, sum of group size x value, and the plain average, which you used in the learning checks but do not report). Also shown is the share of your group in your 50 cities. Do the hand check once, so you can explain where one number comes from. Copy the **completion code and record line** and **paste them at the top of your submission**, before your write-up.

Download your figures

Under your weighted averages table, **Make a figure** builds a figure for one indicator. You choose:

1. **Indicator.** Any of your three. The figure shows its weighted average (the average member's city) for all three periods, next to the **national value** of the same indicator if you tick "Compare with the national values."
2. **What to download:** a **chart (PNG image)**, a **table (CSV)**, or **both** (the default).
3. **Title.** The tool suggests one, for example *poverty percent in the cities where people born in [country] live, compared with the nation: 2000, 2006-2010 and 2020-2024*. You can edit it before you download.

The chart has labeled axes, values on the bars, and a source line. If you ticked the 2024 dollars box, income figures say so. Make one figure per indicator and add a figure number and short caption in your paper.

If something goes wrong

- *Progress gone:* wrong browser, private window or cleared data. Return to the original.
- *Look-up will not match:* check city **and state**, period, and units.
- *Email rejected:* it must end in @northeastern.edu.
- *A number looks wrong:* tell your instructor the group, period, indicator and city.